LET Social Studies: Historical Sources, Civic Duties, and Context

LET · social-studies · BoardPrep lesson v1

Official examination scope

The PRC LEPT TOS and DepEd Araling Panlipunan curriculum guide inform the scope. This original unit teaches source analysis, civic reasoning, and historical context; its examples do not claim to cover all Philippine history or social-science topics.

Learning objectives

- Assess a historical source by origin, audience, time, and purpose.
- Separate a claim from the evidence and context that support it.
- Connect civic duties or rights to an appropriate primary source.

1. Historical sources and provenance

A primary source was created in the period or context being studied, but it is not automatically complete or unbiased. Ask who created it, when, for whom, why, and what the creator could directly observe. A later textbook is a secondary account that may synthesize many sources; it also has an author, evidence base, and interpretive purpose. When accounts disagree, compare provenance and look for independent corroboration before deciding which claim is better supported. Keep what a source says distinct from what the historian infers from it.

2. Context, change, and multiple perspectives

Historical explanation connects people's choices to institutions, resources, beliefs, geography, and events at a particular time. Avoid explaining the past only through today's categories or assuming that a single group experienced an event uniformly. Compare perspectives and consequences, identify what changed and what persisted, and ask whose account is missing from the available record. A causal claim should identify a mechanism and support it with evidence that addresses plausible alternatives. Context helps explain a choice without automatically excusing or condemning it.

3. Civic rights, duties, and the public good

Civic questions should be grounded in the relevant constitutional text, law, institution, and facts. Identify which right, duty, or public responsibility is involved and who has authority to act. The phrase "public good" does not erase individual rights or replace fair process. For an environmental or community issue, name the affected group, observed condition, applicable source, and decision process. Distinguish an ethical recommendation from a legal requirement, and verify current rules before interpreting a real case.

Resolve a discrepancy in two accounts

Question: A diary and a later textbook disagree about when a bridge closed. What should a historian do first?
1. Record the creation date, author, audience, and purpose of each account.
2. Check whether the diary writer directly observed the closure and what "closed" means in context.
3. Compare independent dated records, such as notices, maps, or local reports.
Answer: Compare dates, context, and other records before resolving the discrepancy.
Check: Neither a contemporary diary nor a later textbook is automatically decisive.

Common misconceptions

- A primary source is always more accurate than a later synthesis.

- Historical context is an excuse rather than an explanatory frame.
- A civic principle identifies the exact law and decision-maker.

Practice patterns

- Evaluate provenance before using a source as evidence.
- Name a missing perspective or corroborating record.
- Cite the specific civic authority relevant to a scenario.

Official scope references

Official scope: Enhanced Tables of Specifications for the Licensure Examination for Professional Teachers — Professional Regulation Commission; Professional Regulatory Board for Professional Teachers — https://prc.gov.ph/Pages/PRBv4/ProfessionalTeachersv9.htm
Official scope: PRC Guidelines on the Implementation of the PRC-CHED JMC on LEPT Alignment — Professional Regulation Commission — https://prc.gov.ph/article/guidelines-implementation-prc-ched-jmc-alignment-lept-teacher-education-curriculum

Instructional references

Instructional reference: DepEd K to 12 Araling Panlipunan Curriculum Guide — Department of Education, Philippines — https://www.deped.gov.ph/wp-content/uploads/2019/01/AP-CG.pdf
Instructional reference: 1987 Constitution of the Republic of the Philippines — Republic of the Philippines; text reproduced by The Lawphil Project — https://lawphil.net/consti/cons1987.html
Instructional reference: Jose Rizal National Centennial Commission Collection — National Historical Commission of the Philippines — https://memory.nhcp.gov.ph/articles/the-jose-rizal-national-centennial-commission-collection-of-the-national-historical-commission-of-the-philippines/
Instructional reference: Republic Act No. 10533: Enhanced Basic Education Act of 2013 — Republic of the Philippines — https://www.officialgazette.gov.ph/2013/05/15/republic-act-no-10533/

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